QUICK GUIDE

COMPLEX WAVEFORM

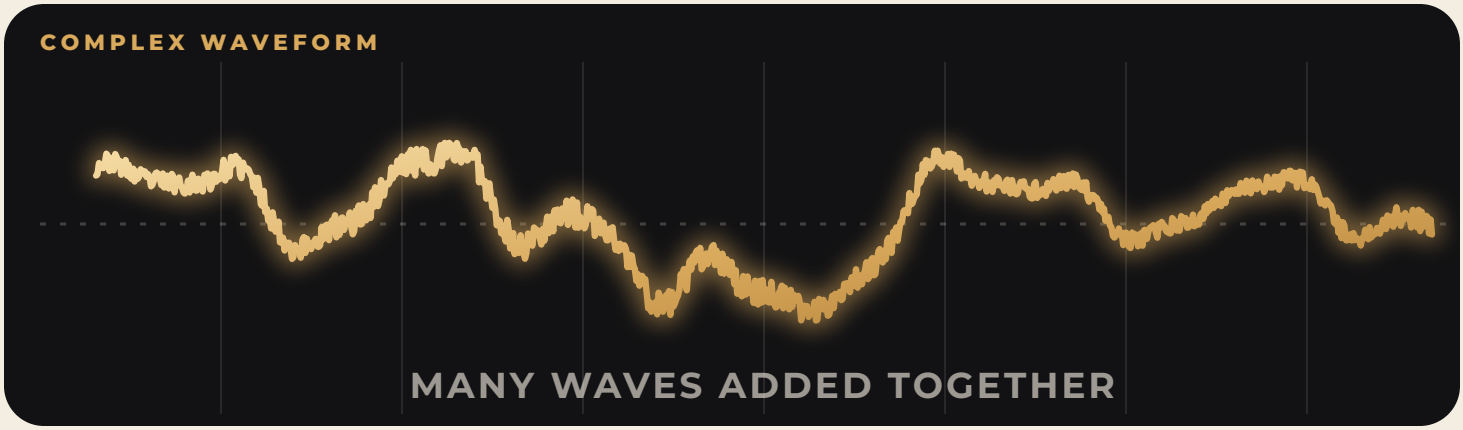
What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

WHAT IT IS

A complex waveform is many sound waves added together. Real music, voices and instruments are all complex waveforms made of a fundamental note plus harmonics and overtones.

HOW IT SOUNDS

Rich and real. Every instrument has its own character.



01

MANY WAVES, ONE SHAPE

Every instrument adds its own pattern.

02

HARMONICS AND OVERTONES

They give every sound its own character.

03

READ THE SHAPE, NOT THE DETAIL

Look for big peaks, thin gaps and changes.

DO THIS TONIGHT

Stop hunting for clean shapes. Read where the energy changes.

- [ ] Zoom out on a track. Find the loud and quiet sections.
- [ ] Mark the breakdowns, builds and drops.
- [ ] Plan your mix-in around those moments.



PRACTICE & CHECK

COMPLEX WAVEFORM: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Every full track you play.
- Vocals and live instruments.
- Reading the big shape shows you breakdowns, builds and drops.

QUICK CHECK

1. What is a complex waveform?

2. What gives each instrument its own character?

3. What should you read on a track's waveform?

Answer key: 1) Many waves added together. 2) Its mix of harmonics and overtones. 3) The big shape: loud, quiet and changes.

REMEMBER

Don't look for clean shapes. Read the energy.

YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Clipped Waveform

